

Toph play guide — addendum

Two things the Sept 21 guide does not cover. All card text re-verified against [scryfall.db](#) on Sept 28, 2026. The main guide's card references and its Bracket 3 header were re-checked and are all still correct — Toph runs exactly three Game Changers (Aura Shards, Enlightened Tutor, Smothering Tithe), which is the cap.

1. The fetch package — six fetches, seven landfall payoffs

The main guide covers landfall payoffs and it covers Traveling Chocobo, but it never connects them to the fetchlands. **Every fetch is two landfall triggers:** once when the fetch itself enters, once when the land it finds enters. That is the whole reason a fetch beats a basic in this deck, and it is why you never cut one for a basic.

Fetch	The fetch itself	The land it finds
Arid Mesa	enters untapped	untapped
Prismatic Vista	enters untapped	untapped
Windswept Heath	enters untapped	untapped
Wooded Foothills	enters untapped	untapped
Grasslands	enters tapped	untapped
Mountain Valley	enters tapped	untapped

Grasslands and Mountain Valley are the ones people misread. The land itself enters tapped, but what it *fetches* comes in untapped — their search text has no tapped clause. They are slower to deploy, not slower to pay off.

Seven landfall payoffs see both triggers: Avenger of Zendikar, Evolution Sage, Felidar Retreat, Lotus Cobra, Rampaging Baloths, Scute Swarm, and Toph, Earthbending Master.

Traveling Chocobo doubles both halves. Its text: *"If a land or Bird you control entering the battlefield causes a triggered ability of a permanent you control to trigger, that ability triggers an additional time."* Each of the two landfall events becomes two, so **one fetch is four landfall triggers**. With Scute Swarm out at six or more lands, every one of those four makes a *copy of Scute Swarm* — a single fetch is four new Swarms.

Note the asymmetry the main guide already flags: Chocobo does **not** double Toph's end-step earthbend, because that trigger is not caused by a land entering. Chocobo is a landfall multiplier only — but across six fetches that is a great deal of landfall.

2. Forge simulation — the AI cannot pilot this deck

Recorded so that no future sim result is read as a verdict on the deck. Across three matchups the Forge AI failed to cast Toph in **18%, 32% and 40%** of games. A diagnostic on the whiff games proved this is a **piloting failure, not a mana failure**:

Finding in the whiff games	What it rules out
13 of 16 ran six turns or longer	Not 'the game ended too early'
81% had a red land on the battlefield	Not colour screw
One game had nine lands plus a Birds of Paradise idle for thirteen turns	Not mana at all
Narrated logs showed Command Tower animated while three artifacts sat idle	Wrong earthbend targets — the guide's rule is artifacts first

Any Toph simulation number is a floor, not a rating. This deck's power is almost entirely sequencing: which permanent to earthbend each end step, stacking Annie Joins Up with Strionic Resonator, running the Stasis Coffin loop, ordering the five counter-modifiers before the doublers. Forge does none of it. A deck that mostly attacks — the mono-black deathtouch deck, for instance — loses far less in translation, so head-to-head sim numbers understate Toph specifically.

Generated Sept 28, 2026. The nine-page main guide remains accurate and is not superseded by this addendum.